NHMEC

Natural Health Ministry Education Center

Community Herbalist Diploma

Level II – Applied Studies

MODULE 16

Community Herbalist Capstone Portfolio & Final Comprehensive Examination

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Module Overview

Congratulations!

You have reached the final module of the NHMEC Community Herbalist Diploma.

Throughout this sixteen-module program, you have developed the knowledge, practical skills, and leadership abilities necessary to educate others about herbal wellness within your community.

You have studied:

• Community Herbalism

• Herbal Preparations

• Medicinal Gardening

• Sustainable Stewardship

• Community Outreach

• Herbal Education

• Nutrition

• Herbal Safety

• Leadership

• Professional Development

• Community Service

• Applied Practicum

Now it is time to demonstrate your competency by organizing the work you have completed throughout this diploma into a professional portfolio that reflects your knowledge, growth, and commitment to ethical community herbal education.

This module concludes with the NHMEC Community Herbalist Final Comprehensive Examination.

Module Objectives

Upon successful completion of this module students will be able to:

• Organize a professional Community Herbalist Portfolio.

• Demonstrate competency in community herbal education.

• Evaluate personal and professional growth.

• Present evidence of practical experience.

• Develop a long-term community service plan.

• Successfully complete the comprehensive final examination.

• Prepare for Level III studies.

Required Reading

Review the **entire Community Herbalist eGuide**.

Review:

• All sixteen modules

• Herb Monographs

• Preparation Journal

• Field Journal

• Community Garden Project

• Leadership Materials

• Educational Resources

• Herbal Safety

• Professional Ethics

• Practicum Documentation

Review all notes before completing the final examination.

Learning Outcomes

Upon successful completion students will demonstrate the knowledge, organization, professionalism, and leadership expected of an NHMEC Community Herbalist.

Instructor Lecture

Becoming a Community Herbalist

A diploma does not make someone a Community Herbalist.

Character does.

Community Herbalists are recognized by:

Their integrity.

Their willingness to serve.

Their commitment to education.

Their love of learning.

Their stewardship of God's creation.

Their respect for others.

Their professionalism.

The greatest Community Herbalists never stop growing.

Reflection

Take a few moments to reflect upon your journey.

Think back to Module One.

Consider everything you have learned.

How have you changed?

What surprised you most?

Which assignment challenged you?

Which project inspired you?

How has your understanding of herbs changed?

How has your understanding of community changed?

Education is not measured only by information gained but also by the person you have become.

Building Your Professional Portfolio

Your Community Herbalist Portfolio represents the work completed throughout this diploma.

Organize your portfolio professionally.

Suggested order:

Title Page

Table of Contents

Professional Biography

Mission Statement

Community Herbalist Philosophy

Résumé (optional)

Certificates

Reflection Essay

Include the Following Projects

Educational Projects

Community Herbalism Essay

Teaching Lesson Plans

Educational Handouts

Workshop Kit

Community Outreach Proposal

Community Nutrition Workshop

Community Herbal Program

Leadership Plan

Volunteer Handbook

Professional Development Plan

Botanical Projects

20 Herb Monographs

Field Journal

Herbarium

Plant Identification Records

Medicinal Garden Design

Pollinator Garden Plan

Seasonal Planting Calendar

Seed Saving Notes

Herbal Preparation Projects

Preparation Journal

Preparation Portfolio

Recipes

Preparation Comparison Charts

Educational Labels

Storage Records

Community Projects

Community Garden Proposal

Community Outreach Calendar

Volunteer Documentation

Community Partnerships

Practicum Report

Community Service Documentation

Photographs

Participant Evaluations

Professional Documents

Mission Statement

Vision Statement

Five-Year Plan

Code of Ethics

Scope of Practice

Operations Manual

Professional Development Portfolio

Continuing Education Plan

Portfolio Presentation

Your portfolio should demonstrate:

Professional appearance

Organization

Accuracy

Creativity

Completeness

Educational value

Growth

Leadership

Integrity

Self-Evaluation

Evaluate yourself in each area.

Rate yourself:

1 Beginning

2 Developing

3 Competent

4 Proficient

5 Advanced

Categories:

Plant Identification

Herbal Preparations

Teaching

Public Speaking

Leadership

Organization

Documentation

Volunteer Service

Professionalism

Community Outreach

Gardening

Communication

Ethics

Time Management

Lifelong Learning

Write one paragraph explaining each rating.

Graduation Reflection

Prepare a reflective essay.

Title:

"My Journey as a Community Herbalist"

Include:

What inspired you to study herbalism.

Your greatest lessons.

Personal growth.

Professional growth.

Future goals.

How you plan to serve your community.

How this diploma has influenced your life.

Minimum Length:

5–8 pages.

Biblical Reflection

Matthew 5:16 (KJV)

"Let your light so shine before men, that they may see your good works, and glorify your Father which is in heaven."

Community Herbalists serve quietly, faithfully, and humbly.

Every garden planted.

Every class taught.

Every child encouraged.

Every family served.

Every volunteer hour.

Every seed saved.

Every act of stewardship brings glory to God.

May your knowledge always be guided by compassion, wisdom, and integrity.

Vocabulary Review

Review all vocabulary from:

Modules 1–15

Students should demonstrate mastery of all terminology introduced throughout this diploma.

Final Capstone Assignment

Community Herbalist Professional Portfolio

Submit your completed portfolio.

The portfolio should include evidence of all required assignments completed throughout the diploma.

Suggested minimum length:

150–250 pages

(Length will vary depending upon photographs, worksheets, journals, and projects.)

Final Comprehensive Examination

Students will complete a comprehensive **Open-Book Examination** consisting of:

100 Multiple Choice Questions

Topics include:

Community Herbalism

Botanical Identification

Medicinal Gardening

Stewardship

Herbal Preparations

Kitchen Herbalism

Nutrition

Teaching Methods

Leadership

Community Outreach

Professional Ethics

Volunteer Management

Documentation

Herbal Safety

Professional Development

Applied Practicum

Passing Score:

80%

Students who do not achieve 80% may review the material and retake the examination.

Graduation Requirements

To receive the

NHMEC Community Herbalist Diploma

students must successfully complete:

✓ Modules 1–16

✓ Required Reading

✓ Vocabulary Assignments

✓ Reflection Questions

✓ Practical Activities

✓ Herb Monographs

✓ Preparation Journal

✓ Herbarium

✓ Community Garden Project

✓ Community Outreach Project

✓ Community Nutrition Project

✓ Leadership Project

✓ Volunteer Handbook

✓ Professional Development Portfolio

✓ Practicum Hours

✓ Practicum Portfolio

✓ Capstone Portfolio

✓ Final Comprehensive Examination

Minimum Overall Average:

80%

Community Herbalist Oath

Upon graduation, students are encouraged to affirm the following pledge:

> **As a graduate of the NHMEC Community Herbalist Diploma Program, I commit myself to serving my community with integrity, humility, compassion, and wisdom. I will strive to preserve traditional herbal knowledge, protect God's creation through responsible stewardship, educate others honestly, continue learning throughout my life, respect professional boundaries, and use my knowledge to encourage wellness through ethical community herbal education. I recognize that true leadership is demonstrated through service, and I dedicate my work to benefiting my community while honoring God through faithful stewardship of His creation.**

Graduation Ceremony (Optional)

Graduates may choose to participate in an NHMEC Graduation Ceremony that includes:

• Presentation of Portfolios

• Recognition of Practicum Projects

• Community Service Recognition

• Diploma Presentation

• Community Herbalist Oath

• Group Photograph

Community Herbal Journal

Write your final journal entry.

Reflect upon:

• The greatest lesson you learned.

• The project you enjoyed most.

• The area where you experienced the most growth.

• Your plans for the next five years.

• Your commitment to serving your community through ethical herbal education.

Module Completion Checklist

☐ Required reading reviewed

☐ Portfolio completed

☐ Self-evaluation completed

☐ Graduation reflection submitted

☐ Community Herbalist Oath signed

☐ Final examination completed

☐ Final grade of 80% or higher

☐ Diploma requirements completed

Congratulations!

You have successfully completed the instructional and applied requirements for the:

NHMEC Community Herbalist Diploma

Level II – Applied Studies

You are now prepared to continue your educational journey into:

NHMEC Level III – Wellness Herbalist Diploma

This advanced diploma builds upon your foundation in community herbalism by introducing advanced herbal formulation, body systems, wellness planning, advanced materia medica, client education, evidence-informed herbal practice, and comprehensive wellness program development.

Continue to learn.

Continue to teach.

Continue to serve.

Continue to steward God's creation with wisdom, humility, and compassion.

"The best Community Herbalists are not those who know the most—but those who faithfully share what they know to strengthen their communities."